

Dallas Center-Grimes Community School District

Board Report from Madison Melchert, Activities Director

Date: April 2026

Spring Activities

As we transition fully into the spring season, our activities are underway despite a challenging start with the weather. While we haven't had as many competition opportunities as we would typically expect at this point, our students and coaches have done an excellent job staying flexible and making the most of every opportunity available.

We were able to host a successful JV/Varsity Boys Track & Field meet, and we are incredibly grateful for the many volunteers who adjusted their schedules to help make that event possible. Both our boys and girls track and field teams have competed when able and have already posted some strong early-season marks. Next week, we look forward to participating in the Drake Relays over three days. With about a month remaining in the season, our teams are beginning to set their sights on the State Meet in May. We have also worked to adjust schedules and add meets where possible to create more opportunities for competition.

Boys Soccer has been able to get several matches in, including three last week, and currently sits at 3–1 overall. Their only loss came to Johnston in a weather-shortened match. They are entering conference play and have a big week ahead, including a trip to Waterloo for a weekend tournament.

Girls Soccer has competed in two matches so far, as their season began a week later due to the IGHS AU calendar adjustment. They currently hold a 1–1 record and are coming off a strong win over Johnston. They will travel to Omaha this week to face two strong opponents, providing a great early-season challenge.

Boys Tennis was finally able to open their season last week at a tournament in Boone, where they placed 3rd with 135 points. Weather has limited additional opportunities, but they are scheduled to compete again later this week, conditions permitting. The group has stayed engaged and ready as they await more consistent match play.

Girls Golf has opened their season with one meet and performed well, especially considering limited time outdoors. They have a busy week ahead with multiple JV and varsity competitions, and we are excited to see their continued growth.

Our Fine Arts programs continue to represent DCG at a high level across multiple areas. Jazz Choir groups Modulation and Dissonance competed at the Iowa Vocal Jazz Championships,

placing 8th and 6th in Class 4A, with Kalya Peters Atanga recognized as an Outstanding Soloist. Jazz 1 earned a standing ovation at the Iowa Jazz Championships, with four students named Outstanding Performers, marking the first time DCG has qualified in Class 4A. *Our Town* opens May 1, and students are performance-ready as the production comes together with a strong message and creative stage design. In visual arts, congratulations to Roxy Monner, Karin Danickova, and Lilly Derry for being named Little Hawkeye All-Conference artists, along with all students who submitted work this year.

Across all programs, it has been great to see our students back outside; competing, practicing, and building toward their goals. As the weather improves, we look forward to more consistent opportunities for our teams to compete and continue their growth throughout the spring season.

Culture & Identity

This spring has continued to highlight the collaborative and supportive culture that defines DCG Activities. Despite weather challenges limiting early competitions, our students, coaches, and families have remained flexible and committed, adjusting schedules and finding ways to create opportunities. That ability to adapt while keeping students at the center reflects the shared purpose across our programs.

A strong example of this was our early-season track and field meet, where volunteers adjusted their schedules to ensure the event could take place. These efforts reinforce the level of support behind our programs and the willingness of our community to step in when it matters most.

As we move further into the spring season, track and field, soccer, tennis, and golf continue to provide meaningful opportunities for students to grow and compete. Many of these events require significant coordination and volunteer support, and they consistently highlight the pride and involvement that make DCG a special place.

Across all areas, our programs continue to reflect DCG's core values. We are collaborative in how we work together, passionate in how we compete and perform, innovative in how we navigate challenges, inclusive in creating opportunities for all students, and supportive in ensuring every student has the chance to succeed.

Operations & Finances

The Activities Department continues to work closely with Sean Shatava, Travis Donahue, and our Business Office as we advance facility improvements and refine operational systems across campus.

The baseball batting cage project is nearing completion and will serve as the first phase of continued enhancements to the baseball facility. We are working closely with the baseball program and our operations team to plan next steps, including future updates to the backstop, dugouts, and fencing.

Our operations team has also spent significant time preparing our outdoor facilities for the spring season. From the stadium to our field event venues, their attention to detail has ensured our spaces are safe, functional, and ready to host competition. Their work behind the scenes continues to make a meaningful impact on the experience of our student-athletes and community.

We also continue to collaborate with OPN, the DCG Booster Club, Technology, Operations and Communications as plans move forward for the installation of a new stadium video board, with the goal of completion later this fall. In addition, we remain engaged in ongoing conversations with OPN and district leadership regarding future campus projects, and we look forward to establishing clearer timelines to help guide planning and decision-making.

Additionally we continue to work in collaboration with the Business Office and Operations to refine and streamline the facility rental process. Our goal is to create a more consistent, clear, and efficient system that better serves both our internal programs and community users while maintaining the quality of our facilities.

Personal Highlight

A personal highlight this month has been the flexibility and adaptability shown by our coaches and student-athletes. With the challenges that come with spring weather, opportunities have been limited at times, but our teams have done a great job staying ready and making the most of every chance they get to compete. That mindset; being prepared, adjusting when needed, and taking advantage of opportunities when they arise, speaks to the commitment and growth happening across our programs.

Looking Ahead

It is hard to believe we are so close to the end of the school year. We have baseball and softball in preparation for their season and post season spring dates waiting for us on the calendar. We have completed big milestones like prom and look forward to celebrating our seniors in the weeks to come.

Madison Melchert

Activities Director

Dallas Center–Grimes High School

